



USER MANUAL

Version 1.0.0 (Lite)

Developed by Juan Pestana

Introduction

Developed by **Juan Pestana**, XPRESSO is a MIDI MPE Sequencer designed to give musicians a new level of expressive control over their sequences.

About This Version: This Lite version is part of an active development cycle. Your real-world usage helps refine future updates.

Bug Reports (technical issues only): juanpestanamusic@gmail.com
Include OS, DAW, version, and steps to reproduce.

Feature Suggestions & Experience Feedback:

Short feedback form link: <https://forms.gle/8FzvMU6Qo12RmtDA7>

Updates are sent through the landing page subscriber list.

Thank you for being part of the early user group.

1. Limitations (Lite Version)

While XPRESSO Lite provides the full core experience, the following restrictions apply compared to the full version:

- **Track Count:** Limited to **1 Track** (Full version supports 16).
- **Modulation Options:** The **Waveform**, **ADSR**, and **MESG** modulation modes are disabled for Slide and Pressure modules.

2. Installation & Setup

XPRESSO runs as a standalone application.

- **Mac:** Open the .dmg file and drag the app to your Applications folder.
- **Windows:** Run the .exe file.

Requirements: XPRESSO must be used with an MPE-compatible plugin or DAW. Ensure your DAW settings are configured for MPE. On Mac, ensure **IAC Drivers** are enabled.

▶ IAC Driver (Bus 13)	☒	☐	☐	☒
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 14)	☒	☐	☐	☒
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 15)	☒	☐	☐	☒
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 16)	☒	☐	☐	☒
Output Ports	Track	Sync	Remote	
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 1)	☒	☐	☒	
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 2)	☐	☐	☐	
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 3)	☐	☐	☐	
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 4)	☐	☐	☐	
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 5)	☐	☐	☐	
▶ IAC Driver (Bus 6)	☐	☐	☐	

Figure 1: Configuring IAC Drivers for MIDI routing.

3. Interface Overview

The application defaults to **Pattern Mode**, which serves as the primary workspace for sequencing and detailed editing. This view provides access to all note data and modulation tools.

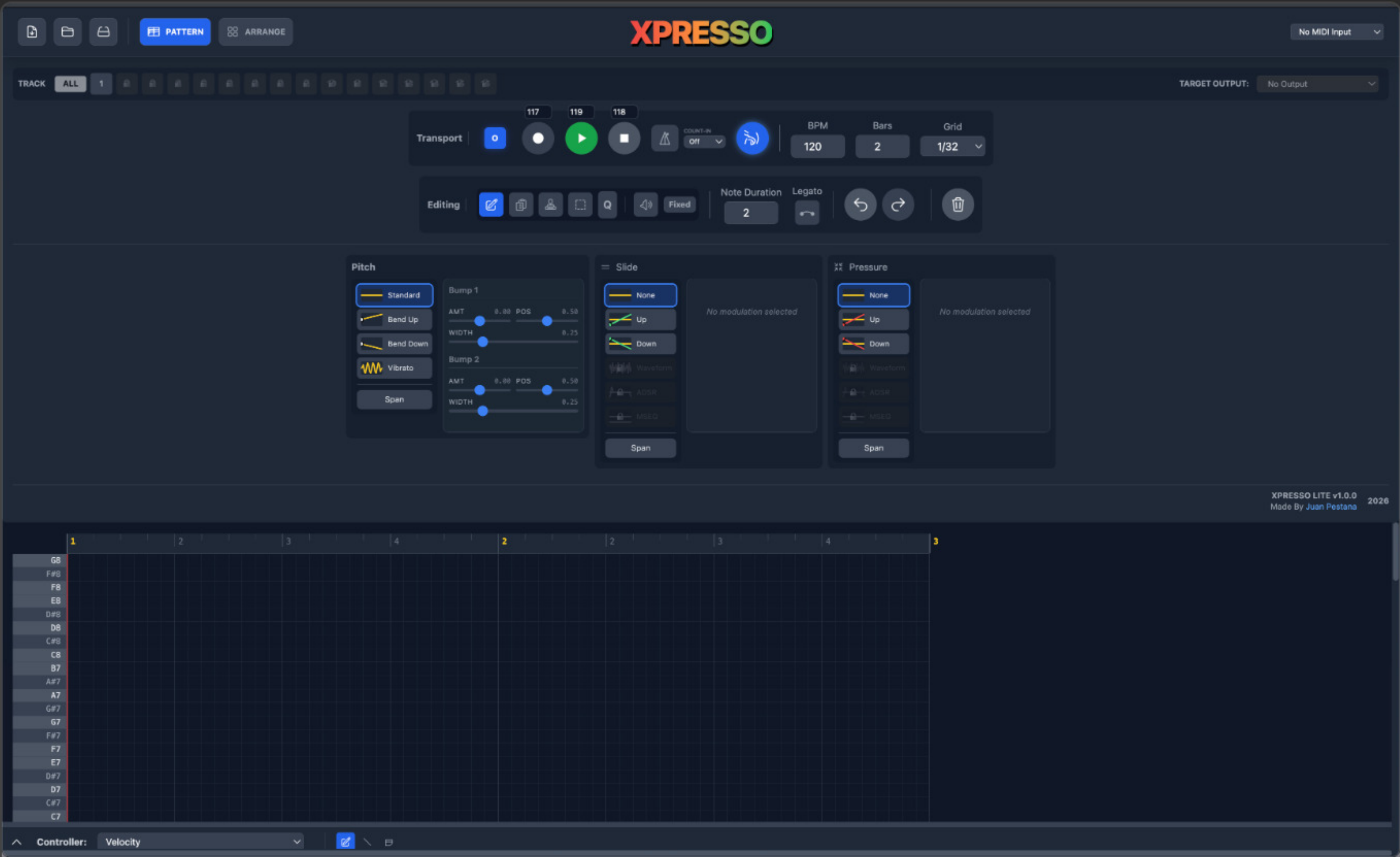


Figure 2: The Pattern View Mode, the primary workspace for sequencing.

Top Bar Navigation

- **PATTERN / ARRANGE:** Toggle buttons to switch views.
TAB Shortcut to swap views.
- **XPRESSO Logo:** Click to fold/unfold the main panel for more workspace.
H Shortcut to toggle panel.
- **MIDI Input:** Top right corner, selects external MIDI devices or IAC drivers.

File Operations



Import MIDI

Imports standard MIDI files.



Import Sequence (.JSON)

Loads XPRESSO sequence files.



Export Sequence (.JSON)

Saves your project.

Note: The .JSON format saves all MPE modulation data accurately.

4. Transport Tools

Overdub



Records new notes on top of existing ones. Features "Smart Overdub" which prevents overlapping notes.

- **Record / Play / Stop:** Standard controls.
*Tip: Clicking **Stop twice** resets the playhead to the first measure.*
- **Metronome & Count-in:** Toggle click track and pre-recording count.



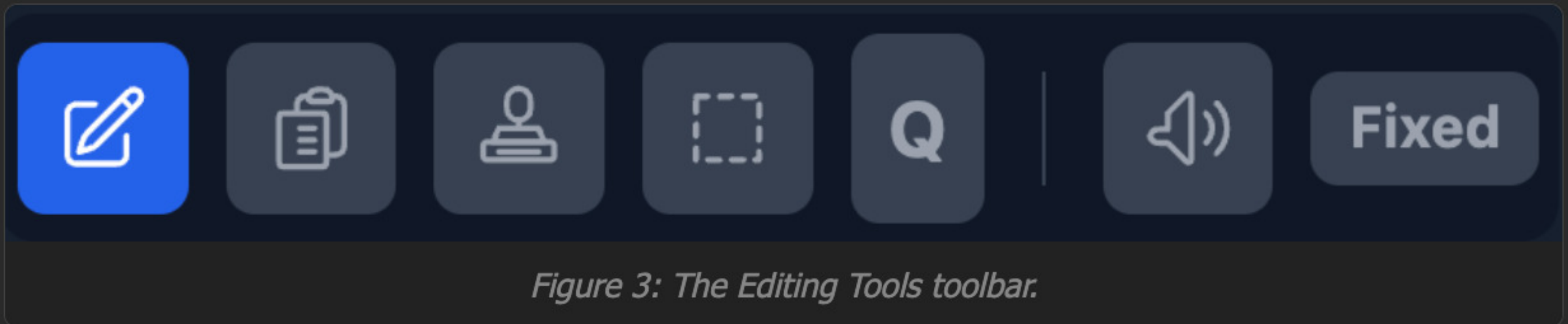
Playhead Following

Toggles auto-scrolling of the timeline.

- **BPM / Bars / Grid:** Adjust tempo, sequence length, and grid resolution.

5. Editing Tools

Located in the main panel, these tools are for precise note and modulation editing.



- **Draw Tool** **1**: Left-click creates notes; Right-click deletes notes.
- **Select Tool** **2**: Left-click selects notes.
- **Apply Setting Tool** **3**: Pastes stored modulation attributes to clicked notes.
- **Copy Settings Tool** **4**: Copies modulation attributes from a note and auto-switches to Apply tool.
- **Q Quantize** **Q**: Quantizes selected note(s).
- **Audition Notes**: Triggers MIDI output to hear notes.
- **Fixed Button**: Forces recorded notes to a fixed MIDI velocity.
- **Note Duration**: Sets length for new notes.
- **Legato**: Smooths modulation transitions between notes without retriggering.

6. MPE Modules

XPRESSO uses MPE (MIDI Polyphonic Expression), meaning modulations are independent per note.

Pitch Module

- **Standard:** Default mode. Features *Bumps* (Amount, Position, Width) and *Bend Up/Down* (Position, Curvature, Ease In/Out, Vibrato).
- **Bend Up/Down:** Automatically pitches towards the next note.
Tip: Hold `Command` over a note to adjust the bend pivot visually.
- **Vibrato:** Adds adjustable vibrato (Rate, Amount, Fade In/Out).

Slide Module (Dimension Y - Timbre)

- **Modes:** None, Up, Down.
- **Parameters (Up):** Position, Curve, Apex, Tilt.
- *Note: Waveform, ADSR, and MSG modules are disabled in Lite.*

Pressure Module (Dimension Z) - Pressure

- **Modes:** None, Up, Down.
- **Parameters:** Same structure as Slide Module.

7. Piano Roll Shortcuts



Figure 4: The Piano Roll Interface displaying notes and waveforms.

- **Cursor Keys:** Move selected note(s).
- **Shift + Up/Down:** Transpose selected note(s) one octave.
- **Shift + Left/Right:** Change selected note(s) length.
- **Delete:** Deletes selected notes.
- **Command + A:** Select all notes.
- **Command + C / V / X:** Copy, Paste, Cut. (Playhead sets the paste spot).
- **Option + Drag:** (In Draw or Select mode) Duplicates notes.
- **Mouse Interaction:** Click & hold to move notes; drag edges to resize.
- **Piano Roll Zoom** `Cmd + Cursor Keys` : Up/Down for vertical zoom, Left/Right for horizontal.
- **Global Zoom** `Cmd + +/-` : Keys for zooming everything.

8. CC Editor

Located below the Piano Roll, the CC Editor allows for global Control Changes alongside MPE.

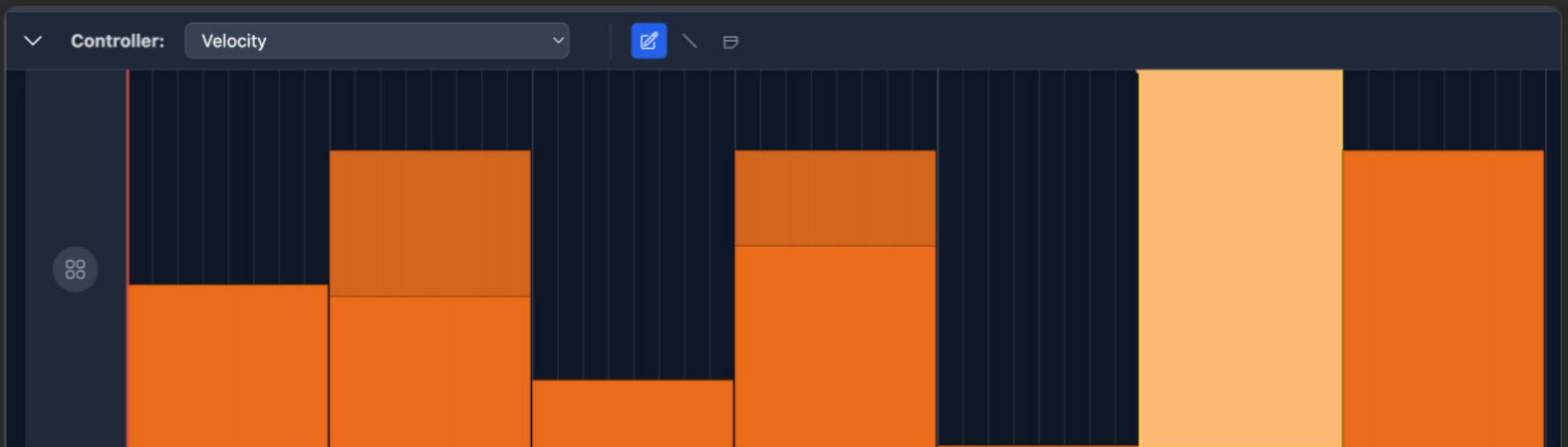


Figure 5: The CC Editor interface showing global automation data.

Important: The CC Editor is **not polyphonic**; it applies globally to the track.

- **Pen Tool:** Freehand draw.
- **Node Tool:** Line draw with node points.
- **Eraser Tool:** Remove data.

9. Arrange Mode

The Arrange view offers a high-level timeline for structuring your music. While Pattern Mode is the primary workspace for creating sequences, Arrange Mode is typically used for the final stage of the workflow, allowing users to structure clips into a full composition. Of course, user preference plays a role, and Pattern Mode may be sufficient for shorter sequences.

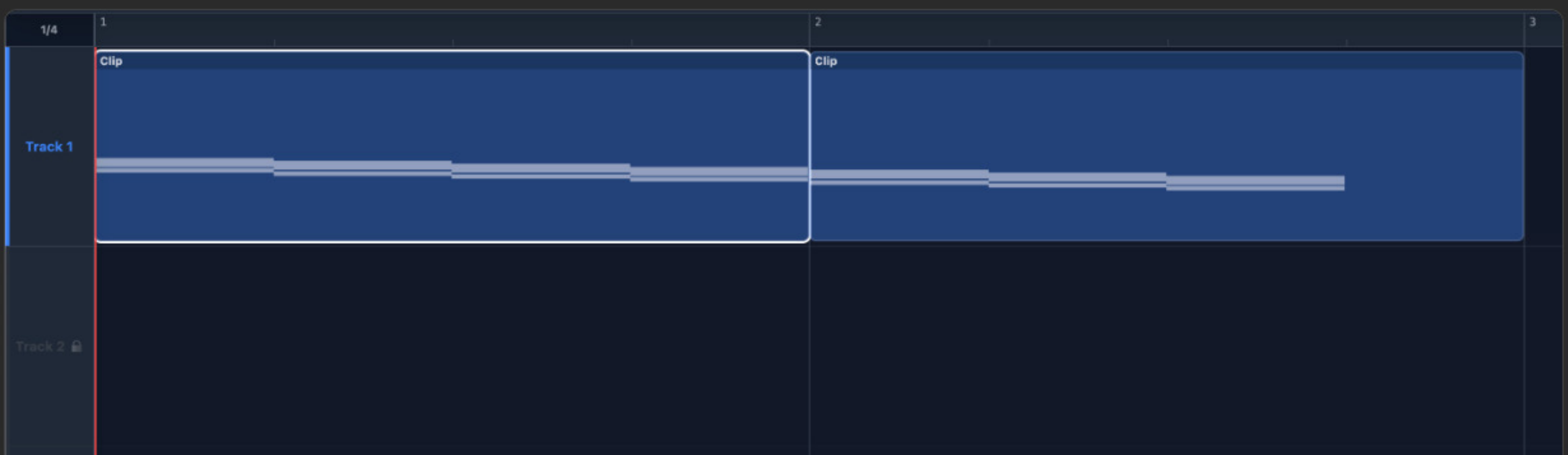


Figure 6: Arrange Mode timeline showing tracks and clips.

- **Create Clip:** Single left-click.
- **Open Pattern:** Double-click a clip (or empty space) to switch to Pattern view.
- **Move/Resize:** Click and hold to move; drag edges to resize.